

ANA ORTEGA PÉREZ

Ph.D. | Lecturer

University of North Carolina, Charlotte

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EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Spanish, UC Davis

2020 – Jun 2026

- Graduate Program in Spanish Linguistics
- Designated Emphasis in Second Language Acquisition
- Dissertation: *The Teaching of Intercultural Communicative Competence in the Spanish as a Foreign Language Classroom through Graded Readers.*
- Advisors: Dr Claudia Sánchez-Gutiérrez & Dr Agustina Carando (UC Davis, department of Spanish & Portuguese); Committee Member: Dr Natividad Hernández Muñoz (Universidad de Salamanca, department of Spanish Linguistics)

Ph.D. in Communications, Universidad de Sevilla, Spain

2014 – 2020

- Graduate Program in Journalism
- Dissertation: *The Structure of Information in Saudi Arabia within the Context of the Media System in Arab Countries.*
- Advisors: Dr Ramón Reig & Dr Rosalba Mancinas-Chávez (Universidad de Sevilla, Spain, department of Journalism II)
- Honors: Sobresaliente Cum Laudem by unanimity

M.A. in International Relations, Universidad Internacional de Andalucía, Spain

2013 – 2014

- Master's dissertation: *Shiite Structural Influences in Lebanese Arab Television: The Cases of al-Manar and al-Mayadeen. The Media-Ideological Apparatus of Hezbollah in the Syrian War.*
- Advisors: Dr Waleeh Saleh (Universidad Autónoma de Madrid, department of Arab and Islamic Studies) & Dr Ramón Reig (Universidad de Sevilla, Spain, department of Journalism II)

B.A. in Journalism, Universidad de Sevilla, Spain

2008 – 2013

RESEARCH INTERESTS & EXPERTISE

Spanish heritage language Critical Language Awareness (CLA) Second Language Acquisition (SLA) Intercultural Communicative Competence Graded Readers Bizarre effect in language learning Plain Language Sociolinguistics Critical Discourse Analysis Open Educational Resources (OER) Media Studies

TEACHING AND COURSE DESIGN EXPERIENCE

Lecturer, University of North Carolina, Charlotte

Aug 2026 – May 2029

COURSES TAUGHT

First Year Elementary Spanish Instruction

- **SPAN 1102** Summer Session II (asynchronous)

Volunteer Course Designer, Davis Language Academy, Davis, CA

2024 – Present

- Design and develop Spanish lessons for diverse learner levels, incorporating communicative, learner-centered approaches with integrated grammar and cultural content.

Associate Instructor, University of California, Davis

2020 – Present

- Taught 15+ undergraduate courses in Spanish language and culture, adapting content and learning objectives to diverse student needs and proficiency levels.
- Designed and redesigned course syllabi, courses, assignments, and assessments to increase student engagement, motivation and critical thinking.

COURSES TAUGHT

Upper Division

- **SPA 111N** Fall 2024 (The Structure of Spanish: Sounds & Words) (in-person)

Spanish for Heritage Speakers

- **SPA 33V** Spring 2026 (virtual)
- **SPA 33** Spring 2024 (in-person)
- **SPA 32** Winter 2024 (in-person)
- **SPA 31** Fall 2022 (in-person)

Second Year Intermediate Spanish Instruction

- **SPA 24** Winter 2025 (Spanish Composition I) (in-person)
- **SPA 23** Spring 2025 (Spanish Composition II) (in-person)

First Year Elementary Spanish Instruction

- **SPA 2V** Winter 2026 (virtual)
- **SPA 2Y** Fall 2025 (hybrid)
- **SPA 3V** Fall 2023 (virtual)
- **SPA 3** Spring 2023 (in-person)
- **SPA 1Y** Spring 2022 (Spanish for travelers) (hybrid)
- **SPA 2** Winter 2022 (in-person); Spring 2021 (in-person); Winter 2021 (virtual)
- **SPA 2** Fall 2021 (virtual)
- **SPA 1** Summer 2021 (virtual); Fall 2020 (virtual)

Assistant Instructor in Multilingual Education for California (Quarter at Aggie Square, UC Davis)

- **Spring 2020** SPA 118 (Spanish for Education) (in-person)
- **Spring 2020** SPA 121 (Introduction to Education Policy Analysis) (in-person)

Graduate Student Research (GRS)

- **Summer 2025** Course design for Spanish for the professions SPA 178A
- **Summer 2025** Course design for heritage SPA 31V & 32V
- **Summer 2024** Course design SPA 3V/Y
- **Summer 2023** Graded Readers writing & design

- **Winter 2023** Course design for heritage SPA 117V (virtual)
- **Summer 2022** Cultural handbooks writing & design
- **Summer 2022** Course design SPA 1V (virtual)
- **Summer 2021** Graded Readers writing & design
- **Summer 2021** Co-created and designed a Canvas-based onboarding and teaching resource hub for SPA 1-3 instructors, providing new and returning TAs with centralized access to university resources, course materials, teaching guides, and quarterly instructional support.

Volunteer Instructor and Course Designer, Casa de Español, Sacramento

2020 – Present

- Created over 50 custom lesson plans and entire courses tailored to specific age groups and proficiency levels, ranging from preschool children to retired adults.
- Created interactive activities and multimedia resources tailored to different proficiency levels and learning styles.
- Led hybrid, in-person and online instruction with an emphasis on real-world communication skills, fostering communicative competence and cultural awareness.

COURSES DESIGNED

- Spanish for Travelers (elementary; in-person)
- Writing and Translation (advanced; virtual)
- Creative Writing (advanced; virtual)
- Basic Pronunciation (elementary; virtual/in-person)
- Laboratorios A, B & C: grammar, vocabulary & culture (elementary/intermediate/advanced; virtual/in-person)
- Conversation labs (elementary/intermediate/advanced; virtual/in-person)
- Grammar & Conversation (advanced; virtual)
- Grammar labs (elementary/intermediate/advanced; virtual/in-person)

COURSES TAUGHT

- Writing and Translation (advanced; virtual)
- TEEN 1 & 2 (elementary; hybrid)
- Spanish to Kids (elementary; virtual/in-person)
- Creative Writing (advanced; virtual)
- Conversation labs (elementary/intermediate/advanced; virtual)
- Intensive subjunctive (high-advanced; virtual)
- Culture around Spain (high-intermediate; virtual)

Volunteer Instructor and Course Designer, International House Davis, Davis

2022 – 2023

- Designed and developed Spanish language curricula and lesson plans tailored to diverse adult learner levels and goals, ranging from graduate students and faculty to retired people.
- Delivered engaging, interactive Spanish instruction focused on communicative competence and cultural awareness.
- Leveraged and tested the principle of 'bizarre effect' to boost learner engagement, enjoyment, and improve language recall and retention.

Erasmus+ Project Coordinator and Facilitator, JENF, Córdoba, Spain

2018 – 2020

- Wrote and developed 5 Erasmus+ project proposals, ensuring alignment with program objectives and funding criteria.

- Designed and facilitated 15+ workshops, seminars, and training activities for participants with diverse linguistic and cultural backgrounds, fostering active engagement, intercultural understanding, and transferable life-skills development through informal learning methods.
- Managed project budgets, including expense tracking, financial reporting, and ensuring efficient resource allocation.
- Coordinated and maintained partnerships with international organizations, fostering effective collaboration and communication.

Media Project Coordinator and Facilitator, Association of Press of Seville,
Spain

2017 – 2018

- Coordinated outreach efforts by establishing partnerships with schools, universities, and community organizations to promote educational media programs.
- Organized logistics for workshops, including scheduling, facilitator coordination, and resource distribution.
- Facilitated workshops for 300+ high school, college students and community organizations on topics such as media literacy, and gender-based violence and sexism in the media, fostering media literacy, critical thinking and awareness.
- Managed a €10,000 project budget and authored evaluation reports used to secure follow-up funding.
- Authored comprehensive final reports for project sponsors, summarizing program outcomes, participant feedback, and recommendations for future initiatives.

Spanish Auxiliary Instructor, Liceo Linguistico Europeo Cadore, Italy

2017

- Supported lead Spanish teachers and other subject instructors, including science, by assisting with lesson preparation and classroom activities.
- Facilitated students' comprehension and use of Spanish terminology across different subjects to reinforce language skills in varied academic contexts.
- Participated in extracurricular activities to promote Spanish language and culture beyond the classroom.
- Helped create engaging learning environments to promote Spanish language acquisition and cultural awareness.

Volunteer Spanish Instructor for Refugees, CEAR, Sevilla, Spain

2015 – 2016

- Provided beginner and intermediate Spanish language instruction to refugees and asylum seekers.
- Developed accessible lesson plans focused on everyday communication and integration skills.
- Fostered a supportive learning environment attentive to the cultural and emotional needs of students.
- Assisted students in navigating local systems and accessing community resources through language support.
- Collaborated with other volunteers and staff to organize language and cultural orientation activities.

PUBLICATIONS – PUBLISHED, SUBMITTED & IN PROGRESS

PEER-REVIEWED ARTICLES & BOOK CHAPTERS

Linguistics Field

Ortega Pérez, A., Hernandez, A., Houck, L. & Carando, A. (in prep). Bridging Language and Profession: The Role of the Linguistic Landscape in a Spanish for the Profession course.

González Bastidas, A., **Ortega Pérez, A.** & Carando, A. (submitted). "Critical Language Awareness and Plain Language: Pedagogical Approaches for Spanish Heritage Learners". *Critical Discourse Studies*.

Garabaya-Casado, E., Hernandez, A., Peraza, B., Ruiz-Alonso Bartol, A. & **Ortega Pérez, A.** (submitted). Mapping Spanish Heritage Language Programs in California's Higher Education: Insights from Institutional Analysis and Instructor Perspectives.

Carando, A., Jiménez-Silva, M. & **Ortega Pérez, A.** (2026). Centering Bilingualism, Cultivating Teachers: Translingual Nidos as a Practice-Based Pathway for Heritage Spanish Speakers. California Council Teacher Education (CCTE) Spring 2026 Research Monograph.

Ortega Pérez, A. & González Bastidas, A. (2026). Learning Through the Senses: Integrating Embodied Learning, Plain Language and Critical Language Awareness in Heritage Spanish Education. *Brújula: Revista Internacional de Estudios Latinoamericanos*. <https://doi.org/10.58748/AMAGLS>

Sanchez-Gutierrez, C., Minnillo, S., **Ortega Pérez, A.** & Ruiz Alonso Bartol, A. (2025). Does order-of-instruction matter? A language program intervention for preterite-imperfect learning. *Foreign Language Annals*, 1-26. <https://doi.org/10.1111/flan.70012>

Fernández-Mira, P. & **Ortega Pérez, A.** (2025). El componente lúdico y socioafectivo en el aula de español como L2: propuesta didáctica con *Black Stories*. In Blanco Canales, A. & Boillos Pereira, M.M. (coords.) *Entre emociones y lenguas: Nuevas perspectivas y buenas prácticas para la enseñanza*, pp. 59-74. Octaedro.

Sánchez-Gutiérrez, C., **Ortega Pérez, A.**, Ruiz Alonso Bartol, A., Fernández Mira, P., Querrien, D. & Dykstra, S. (2024). Spanish language teachers' experiences during the pandemic: From in-person to online teaching and back. In Goertler, S. & Gleason, J. *Technology-mediated Crisis Response in Language Studies*, pp. 143-162. Equinox Publishing.

Querrien, D., Ruiz-Alonso-Bartol, A., Sánchez-Gutiérrez, C., Fernández-Mira, P. & **Ortega Perez, A.** (2024). Formation à la recherche qualitative à distance et en contexte de crise: le cas d'une équipe féminine internationale à la suite de la transition d'urgence en ligne 2020. In Morrisette, J., Demaziere, D. & Dupont-Leclerc, M. M. *Former et se former en recherche qualitative*, pp. 61-78. Presses de l'Université Laval.

Journalism Field

Ortega-Pérez, A. & Parks, D. (in prep). La estructura de la comunicación en Estados Unidos. En Mancinas Cháves, R. & Enriquez Jiménez-Yáñez, C. (coords.). *Los medios de comunicación en Iberoamérica. Estructura, propiedad y relaciones de poder de los medios en la región*.

Suárez-Romero, M., & **Ortega-Pérez, A.** (2019). Género y opinión. El rol secundario de las mujeres en los espacios periodísticos. *Iqual. Revista de género e igualdad*, (2), pp. 133-146. <https://doi.org/10.6018/iQual.324321>

Sussi de Oliveira, J., **Ortega Pérez, A.** & Reig, R. (2018). El tratamiento de la prensa española de la crisis política de Brasil: el impeachment de Dilma Rousseff en los periódicos *El País* y *El Mundo*. *Eptic. Revista electrónica internacional de economía política da informação, da comunicação e da cultura*, 20(2), pp. 125-141. <https://hdl.handle.net/11441/95111>

Sanz, A. T., Otero, J. M. R., & **Ortega Pérez, A.** (2018). Populismo y hegemonía en el Estado Islámico: la construcción del Estado califal en la revista propagandística Dabiq. *Communication & Society*, 31(2), pp. 155-174. <https://doi.org/10.15581/003.31.2.155-174>

Zurbano-Berenguer, B., **Ortega Pérez, A.**, & Tarín Sanz, A. (2017). Violencias contra las mujeres en contextos islámicos. Representación y discurso de la prensa de referencia de España. *Estudios sobre el Mensaje Periodístico*, 23(2), 123. <https://doi.org/10.5209/ESMP.58030>

Fernández Ruiz, Rafael & **Ortega Pérez, A.** (2017). Mundo árabe e islámico: en busca de un modelo propio en un entorno globalizado. In Reig, R. & Labio Bernal, A. *El laberinto mundial de la comunicación*, pp. 185-202. Anthropos.

Mancinas Chávez, R., **Ortega Pérez, A.**, & Vidal Bonifaz, F. J. (2016). La penetración de sectores ajenos a la comunicación en los grupos mediáticos. El caso del Grupo Televisa. *Global Media Journal México*, 13(24), pp. 43-58.

Suárez-Romero, M., & **Ortega-Pérez, A.** (2015). Prácticas comunicacionales alternativas en la concienciación medioambiental: la función crítica del humor gráfico. *Razón y Palabra*, (91).

BOOK COORDINATION

Muñoz Fernández, N., Sussi de Olivera, J. & **Ortega Pérez, A.** (Coords.) (2018). Aportación interdisciplinar a los retos de la comunicación y la cultura en el siglo XXI. Egregius Ediciones.

Ortega Pérez, A. & García-Prieto, V. (Coords.) (2017). *Voces alternativas: investigación multidisciplinar en comunicación y cultura*. Egregius Ediciones.

BOOK REVIEWS

Ortega Pérez, A. (2022). Book Review *Aportes del CAES a la enseñanza del español como lengua extranjera: estudios aplicados de gramática y pragmática*, edited by C. Ballester de Celis & M. Sampedro Mella. *Spanish and Portuguese Review*, 8, 100–101.

Ortega Pérez, A. (2016). Book Review *Crisis del sistema, crisis del periodismo. Contexto estructural y deseos de cambio*, by R. Reig. *Revista Doxa Comunicación*, (22), 178–179.

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

González-Bastidas, A. & **Ortega Pérez, A.** (2025). *Adopt a Doc: Linguistic justice from university to community*. PLAIN eJournal, 7(1), 26–28.

González-Bastidas, A. & **Ortega Pérez, A.** (2025). *Adopta un Doc: Justicia Lingüística de la universidad a la comunidad*. PLAIN eJournal, 7(1), 29–31.

CONFERENCE PROCEEDINGS

Mancinas Chávez, R., Nogales Bocio, A. I., **Ortega Pérez, A.** & Moya, D. (2016). Los estudios de Economía Política de la Comunicación en España: grupos y resultados. III Congreso Nacional sobre Metodología de la investigación en Comunicación, Málaga, Spain.

Ortega Pérez, A. (2016). El panorama mediático de la región del Golfo. Principales medios de comunicación y estructuras de propiedad. I Congreso Internacional Comunicación y Pensamiento. Comunicracia y Desarrollo Social, Sevilla, Spain.

Ortega Pérez, A. (2015). Influencias chiíes en la televisión árabe libanesa: los casos de Al-Manar y Al-Mayadeen. El aparato mediático-ideológico de Hezbollah en la guerra de Siria (2015). IV Sociedad Latina de Comunicación Social, La Laguna, Spain.

Ortega Pérez, A. & Suárez-Romero (2015). La evolución de la mujer como creadora de opinión. El caso de *El País*. III International Conference on Media Ethics, Sevilla, Spain.

Ortega Pérez, A. (2015). Medios de comunicación árabes. Crecientes casos de islamización mediática tras la Primavera Árabe. III International Conference on Media Ethics. Sevilla, Spain.

Ortega Pérez, A. (2013). Aproximación al contenido publicitario en la Televisión Digital Terrestre. II International Conference Gender and Communication, Sevilla, Spain.

ORAL PRESENTATIONS & POSTERS AT CONFERENCES

- Minillo, S., **Ortega Pérez, A.**, González Bastidas, A. Hernandez, A., Sperber, L. Wang, H.C., Withhaus, C. (June 2026). Building Critical AI Literacy through Peer and AI Review + Reflection (PAIR) in English and Spanish writing classes. Writing and Computers conference, Charlotte, NC.
- González Bastidas, A. & **Ortega Pérez, A.** (Apr 2026). Empowering heritage speakers through student-created OER Graded Readers. XVI Annual Hispanic Studies Graduate Student Conference, Riverside, CA.
- González Bastidas, A. & **Ortega Pérez, A.** (Apr 2026). 'Deuda lingüística institucional: Expectativas normalizadas del servicio en español en instituciones financieras de California'. International Workshop on Spanish Sociolinguistics, Georgetown, Washington D.C.
- Ortega Pérez, A.**, Hernandez, A., Carando, A. & Houck, L. (Apr 2026). 'Bringing the public into the classroom: using linguistic landscapes to foster critical language awareness in professional Spanish courses'. International Workshop on Spanish Sociolinguistics, Georgetown, Washington D.C.
- Jiménez-Silva, M., Carando, A. & **Ortega Pérez, A.** (Mar 2026). 'Centering Bilingualism, Cultivating Teachers: Nidos Translingüísticos as a Practice-Based Pathway for Heritage Spanish Speakers'. CTE SPAN 2026, Sacramento, CA.
- Carando, A., González Bastidas, A. & **Ortega Pérez, A.** (Feb 2026). 'Becoming Language Advocates: Digital Humanities and Critical Pedagogy in Heritage Language Education'. Fifth International Conference on Heritage/Community Languages. Los Angeles, CA.
- Hernandez, A., **Ortega Pérez, A.** (Feb 2026). 'Empowering heritage language writers: implementing writing self-efficacy strategies in the classroom'. 13th National Symposium on Spanish as a Heritage Language, Lubbock, TX.
- González Bastidas, A., **Ortega Pérez, A.**, Peraza, B. & Ruppel, L. (Feb 2026). 'Negotiating AI in Spanish Heritage Classrooms: Ethics, Identity, and Emotional Resilience'. 13th National Symposium on Spanish as a Heritage Language, Lubbock, TX.
- Carando, A., **Ortega Pérez, A.** & González Bastidas, A. (Jan 2026). 'From Passive Recipients to Active Advocates: A Pedagogical Framework for Community-Engaged Heritage Spanish Education'. Hawaii International Conference on Education, Honolulu, Hawaii.
- Hernandez, A., **Ortega Pérez, A.** & Ruiz-Alonso Bartol, A. (Dec 2025). 'Writing Self-Efficacy as a Pedagogical Tool in Multilingual Writing Classes'. 2025 Scholarship of Teaching and Learning Conference. University of California, Davis. Davis, California.
- Ortega Pérez, A.** & González Bastidas, A. (Dec 2025). 'Digital Humanities for Linguistic Justice: Human-Focus Narratives in the Latine Co-Lab'. 2025 Scholarship of Teaching and Learning Conference. University of California, Davis. Davis, California.
- González Bastidas, A. & **Ortega Pérez, A.** (Nov 2025). 'High-Tech, Low Clarity: California's Unmet Obligation to Provide Plain Spanish in the Age of AI'. 2025 Plain Language Conference. Plain Language Association International. Brussels, Belgium.
- Ortega Pérez, A.** & González Bastidas, A. (Jun 2025). 'Humanidades digitales y justicia lingüística: transformación curricular y servicio comunitario en tiempos de políticas restrictivas'. Observatorio Instituto Cervantes, Harvard University, Boston, Massachusetts.
- González Bastidas, A. & **Ortega Pérez, A.** (May 2025). 'Integrating Critical Language Awareness (CLA) and Linguistic Rights in Heritage Spanish Language Pedagogy'. Advances in Second/Foreign Language Acquisition (ASeFoLA 2025), University of Nicosia, Cyprus.

- González Bastidas, A. & **Ortega Pérez, A.** (May 2025). 'Plain Language and Critical Language Awareness: Empowering Heritage Speakers through Financial Literacy Research'. 12th National Symposium on Spanish as a Heritage Language, Northwestern University, Evanston, Illinois.
- González Bastidas, A. & **Ortega Pérez, A.** (Mar 2025). 'Plain Legal Spanish in Financial Contracts: Comparing the US with Spanish-Speaking countries'. American Association for Applied Linguistics Conference (AAAL 2025), Denver, Colorado.
- Ortega Pérez, A.** & González Bastidas, A. (Apr 2025). "Linguistic Rights Empowerment and Social Justice: Integrating Plain Language, Legal Design and Critical Language Awareness in Spanish Heritage Language Teaching". Variar, Quebrar, Desquebrar, University of California, Berkeley.
- Houck, L., Ruiz Alonso Bartol, A., de Blas Hernández, S. & **Ortega Pérez, A.** (Mar 2025). 'From Graded Readers to Conversational Tools: Developing and Adapting OERs for Spanish Courses'. 2025 Language OER Conference. Open Language Resource Center, University of Kansas.
- González, A., **Ortega Pérez, A.** & Alíns Breda, D. (Jun 2024). "Programa de lectura (Graded Readers): aprendizaje socio-emocional y visibilización de comunidades latinx, indígenas y LGBTQIA+". American Association of Teachers of Spanish and Portuguese Conference (AATSP 2024), Portland, Oregon.
- Sánchez Gutiérrez, C. González Bastidas, A. & **Ortega Pérez, A.** (Feb 2024). "Writing graded readers for intercultural awareness: Can ChatGPT help?" Southwest Conference of Language Teaching (SWCOLT 2024), Honolulu, Hawaii.
- De Blas Hernández, S. & **Ortega Pérez, A.** (Feb 2024) "Achieving ACTFL's Culture Standards through Embodied/Experiential Learning". Southwest Conference of Language Teaching (SWCOLT 2024), Honolulu, Hawaii.
- Querrien, D., Sánchez Gutiérrez, C., Robles García, P., Alonso-Bartol. A., Fernández Mira-P., **Ortega Pérez, A.** & Dykstra, S. (Mar 2024). "Technology in the language classroom: Lessons learned from the pandemic". Southwest Conference of Language Teaching (SWCOLT 2024), Honolulu, Hawaii.
- Ortega Pérez, A.**, Sánchez Gutiérrez, C., Alonso-Bartol. A., Fernández Mira-P. & Querrien, D. (Mar 2024). "Documenting Spanish language teachers' experiences during the pandemic from in-person to online teaching and back". American Association for Applied Linguistics Conference (AAAL 2024), Portland, Oregon.
- Fernández Mira-P., Alonso-Bartol. A., **Ortega Pérez, A.**, Sánchez Gutiérrez, C. & Querrien, D. (Mar 2023). "Lessons learned from the COVID-19 pandemic: Teachers' and students' experiences in a beginner Spanish program". American Association for Applied Linguistics Conference (AAAL 2023), Portland, Oregon.
- Ortega Pérez, A.** (May 2022). "Code-switching and critical pedagogy in the Spanish heritage language of the United States". 8th Symposium on Language Research, Davis, California.
- García Cardona, J. & **Ortega Pérez, A.** (Oct 2021). "Use of Code-Switching in the Educational Context of Heritage Speakers". Shepard Symposium on Social Justice, University of Wyoming, Wyoming.

Journalism Field

- Ortega Pérez, A.** (2018). "Political, economy and media interdependence in Arab media: study of its ownership and the consequences for Journalism". World Congress for Middle Eastern Studies, University of Seville.
- Mancinas Chávez, R., Nogales Bocio, A. I., **Ortega Pérez, A.** & Moya, D. (2016). Los estudios de Economía Política de la Comunicación en España: grupos y resultados. III Congreso Nacional sobre Metodología de la investigación en Comunicación, Málaga, Spain.

- Ortega Pérez, A.** (2016). El panorama mediático de la región del Golfo. Principales medios de comunicación y estructuras de propiedad. I Congreso Internacional Comunicación y Pensamiento. Comunicracia y Desarrollo Social, Sevilla, Spain.
- Ortega Pérez, A.** (2015). Influencias chiíes en la televisión árabe libanesa: los casos de Al-Manar y Al-Mayadeen. El aparato mediático-ideológico de Hezbollah en la guerra de Siria (2015). IV Sociedad Latina de Comunicación Social, La Laguna, Spain.
- Ortega Pérez, A.** & Suárez-Romero (2015). La evolución de la mujer como creadora de opinión. El caso de *El País*. III International Conference on Media Ethics, Sevilla, Spain.
- Ortega Pérez, A.** (2015). Medios de comunicación árabes. Crecientes casos de islamización mediática tras la Primavera Árabe. III International Conference on Media Ethics. Sevilla, Spain.
- Ortega Pérez, A.** (2013). Aproximación al contenido publicitario en la Televisión Digital Terrestre. II International Conference Gender and Communication, Sevilla, Spain.

INVITED TALKS

- Mínillo, S., González Bastidas, A., **Ortega Pérez, A.** & Hernandez, A. (2026). 'Human-in-the-loop Automated Writing Feedback and More! Peer and AI Review + Reflection in Spanish Heritage and ESL Classes'. Davis Language Center, University of California, Davis.
- Ortega Pérez, A.** & Ruiz Alonso-Bartol, A. (2025). 'Process-based Approaches to Written Feedback in Heritage Courses'. Graduate student showcase: Spanish in California'. University of California, Davis.
- González Bastidas, A. & **Ortega Pérez, A.** (2025). 'Plain Legal Spanish in Financial Contracts: Comparing the US with Spanish-Speaking Countries'. Graduate student showcase: Spanish in California'. University of California, Davis.
- Ortega Pérez, A.** & Araya, V. (2024). "How to attract the readers". Symposium 'Spanish beyond the academia'. University of California, Davis.
- Ortega Pérez, A.** (2024). Grad Panel for undergrad research. URC Mentor-Mentee Program.
- Ortega Pérez, A.** (2023) 'Exploring academic pathways with Spanish: From graduate student to researcher and educator'. SPA 116 Applied Linguistics. University of California, Davis.
- Alins Breda, D., Dykstra, S. & **Ortega Pérez, A.** (2022). 'Explotación de Graded Readers en un programa de lectura de español de primer año'. The Teaching of Spanish in College SPA 390. University of California, Davis.
- Ortega Pérez, A.**, Ruiz Cabrera, S. & James Trench, J. (2017). Los medios de comunicación internacionales en la investigación en comunicación. Laboratorio de Estudios en Comunicación. University of Seville.
- Ortega Pérez, A.** & Mancinas Chávez. R. (2016). Los nuevos estereotipos de género en los dibujos animados: El asombroso mundo de Gumball y Hora de aventuras. III International Conference on Gender and Communication. University of Seville.

OPEN EDUCATIONAL RESOURCES (OER)

- Mi primer año en Davis* (SPA 1)
- La quinceañera* (SPA 1)
- Quarter Abroad en Argentina* (SPA 1)

► [Link](#) to Graded Readers, cultural handbooks and activities. UC Davis Creative Commons

ACADEMIC SERVICE AND OUTREACH

Co-founder Latine Co-Lab

2023 – Present

Collaborative inter-university initiative involving institutions in California and out-of-state, centering Latine students and scholars through projects on Plain Language, Critical Language Awareness, Legal Design, in-service learning, and multilingualism.

► [Padlet Latine Co-Lab](#)

Graduate Mentor, TeachUp, UC Davis

Winter 2026

Provided one-on-one peer mentoring to 2 Graduate Teaching Assistants, including classroom observation, pedagogical feedback, and ongoing support to enhance teaching confidence and effectiveness in U.S. and intercultural higher education contexts.

Undergraduate Mentor, Global Impact Fellowship, UC Davis

2025 – 2026

Mentored an interdisciplinary student team in research and outreach for Latine Co-Lab. Guided project design, collaboration, and community engagement, supporting the development of communication strategies and public-facing materials that advance cultural inclusion and equitable access to information.

Undergraduate Mentor, Undergraduate Research Center, UC Davis

2024 – 2025

Mentored 4 undergraduate students conducting research in Linguistics, History, and International Relations. Supported them in honors thesis design, data collection, and writing, as well as providing guidance on graduate school applications and networking opportunities.

Symposium Organizer: *Human-center narratives and collaboration*, UC Davis

Dec 2025

Organized a symposium through the Latino Co-Lab in partnership with UC Riverside SOCALab, Univision, and International House Davis. The event featured guest speakers and workshops showcasing Plain Language and human-centered communication to enhance linguistic accessibility, empathy, and collaboration across English-Spanish contexts.

Symposium Organizer: *Spanish beyond the Academia*, UC Davis

May 2024

Organized a symposium bringing together professionals from diverse fields to share how they use Spanish in their work. Designed event concept, identified and invited speakers, coordinated logistics, moderated sessions, and facilitated discussions between professionals and students.

Symposium Co-chair: 9th Cluster on Language Research Symposium, UC Davis

May 2023

Co-led planning and execution of an interdisciplinary symposium on language research. Facilitated review of proposals, scheduling, budgeting and event promotion.

Colloquium Co-chair: 16th Samuel G. Armistead, UC Davis

Apr 2023

Organized a departmental colloquium focused on Hispanic linguistics and literature, overseeing speaker invitations, scheduling, venue booking, budgeting, and participant engagement.

Coordinator Spanish Heritage program, UC Davis 2022 – 2024
Oversaw curriculum development and course coordination for Spanish for Heritage Speakers. Supported instructors and promoted best practices for heritage language pedagogy.

Coordinator Spanish Heritage Tutoring program, UC Davis 2022 – 2024
Improved and managed a peer tutoring program specifically for heritage language learners. Recruited and trained 12 peer tutors on effective tutoring strategies and cultural responsiveness. Designed customized tutoring materials and lesson plans tailored to heritage language needs. Conducted regular assessments to monitor student progress and tutor effectiveness, adjusting the program accordingly to maximize learning outcomes.

Lead TA SPA 1-32, 3V/Y, 31, 32, 33, UC Davis 2021 – Present
Provided pedagogical support and mentorship for 15+ instructors and 2 program directors. Designed shared teaching resources and coordinated instructional planning.

Co-organizer of Journalism international conferences and symposiums, University of Seville 2013 – 2020
Collaborated in the planning and execution of conferences on media, communication, and journalism. Responsibilities included speaker outreach, proposal reviews, and publication of proceedings.

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Effective Class Assessments with Transparent Design	<i>Feb 2026</i>
Accreditation Course for DELE B1-B2 Examiners, Instituto Cervantes	<i>Oct – Dec 2025</i>
2025 PLONS: Bringing Ungrading to Language Teaching, University of Arizona	<i>Sept – Nov 2025</i>
The use of AI in language teaching, ELE International	<i>Jul – Sept 2025</i>
University Specialization Course in Teaching Spanish as a Foreign Language to Children and Adolescents, ELE International	<i>Aug – Oct 2025</i>
Simplifying Course Design, Center for Educational Effectiveness, UC Davis	<i>Jul 2025</i>
Teaching the Whole Class, Michigan State University	<i>Jun – Jul 2025</i>
Language Teaching with Generative AI, Michigan State University	<i>Jun 2025</i>
Equitable Syllabus Design, Center for Educational Effectiveness, UC Davis	<i>Jun 2025</i>
Fostering Student Motivation, Center for Educational Effectiveness, UC Davis	<i>May 2025</i>
Designing Learning Activities through a UDL Lens, Center for Educational Effectiveness, UC Davis	<i>Apr 2025</i>
From Passive to Participatory: Active Learning Strategies for Discussion Success, Center for Educational Effectiveness, UC Davis	<i>Mar 2025</i>
Mentoring Undergraduate Students in the Social Sciences, Undergraduate	<i>Feb 2025</i>

Research Center, UC Davis

Classroom Strategies to Support First-Generation Students, Center for Educational Effectiveness, UC Davis Nov 2024

Fostering Inclusive Learning Communities through Accessibility, Center for Educational Effectiveness, UC Davis Nov 2023

Creating Inclusive Classrooms, Center for Educational Effectiveness, UC Davis Jan 2023

Graduate Certificate in Writing Theory and Practice, University Writing Program, UC Davis May 2022

Conflict Competence, GradPathways Institute for Professional Development, UC Davis Apr 2022

2023 Virtual Heritage Language Teacher Workshop, National Heritage Language Resource Center, University of California, Los Angeles Jun – Jul 2023

Certificate Series: Teaching and Learning Complex (TLC), Active Learning Spaces, UC Davis Mar – Jun 2022

2020 ACCELERATE Asynchronously Self-Paced Course, Center for Educational Effectiveness, UC Davis Oct 2020

EDITORIAL EXPERIENCE

Peer Reviewer in Communication, Journalism, History & Literature journals 2016 – Present
(*iQual*, *Ámbitos*, *Revista Historia Caribe*, *Revista Inclusiones*, *Estudios sobre el Mensaje Periodístico*, *Brújula*)

Editorial Committee in *Ámbitos: Revista Internacional de Comunicación* 2016 – 2018

HONORS, AWARDS, GRANTS AND FELLOWSHIPS

Edward R. Murrow Awards, Regional Winner, RTDNA May 2026
Collaborative recognition for *De No Sabo a Sí Sé*. Contributed as a researcher, plain language expert and educator.

Outstanding Teaching Award, Spanish and Portuguese department, UC Davis Jun 2026

Global Impact Fellowship, UC Davis Global Affairs 2025 – 2026

Graduate Student Association (GSA) Special Projects Fund, UC Davis GSA 2025

Graduate Student Association (GSA) Research Expenses Grant, UC Davis GSA 2025

Global Grad Grant, UC Davis Global Learning Hub 2025

Dissertation Writing Fellowship , Spanish and Portuguese department, UC Davis	<i>Jun 2024</i>
Graduate Student Travel Awards , Spanish and Portuguese department, UC Davis	<i>2023 – 2024</i>
Excellence in Teaching Award , Spanish and Portuguese department, UC Davis	<i>Jun 2022</i>
Muslim Women and the Media Training , Henry Luce Foundation	<i>Oct 2019</i>
Research Grant for Visiting Stay , Université Paris VIII, France, awarded by Universidad Internacional de Andalucía	<i>May – Jul 2015</i>

MEMBERSHIP IN PROFESSIONAL ORGANIZATIONS

American Association of Teachers of Spanish and Portuguese (AATSP)	<i>2021 – Present</i>
American Association for Applied Linguistics (AAAL)	<i>2023 – Present</i>
Asociación de la Prensa de Sevilla	<i>2017 – Present</i>
Laboratorio de Estudios en Comunicación	<i>2015 – Present</i>

LANGUAGES

Spanish	Native speaker
English	Near native level
Italian	Upper Intermediate level
Portuguese	Elementary level

REFERENCES

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